

Andrews's plan calls for Billy to make the payments to his sisters for years after Mr. Andrews's death. The money for these annual payments will come from the profits of "his business." Is this unusual? No. Business owners, entrepreneurs, and physicians often find themselves in similar situations (see Tables [6-5](#) and [6-6](#)).

In essence, Billy will be required to heavily subsidize his sisters' lifestyle, a lifestyle predicated on conspicuous consumption. Mr. Andrews feels "fairly certain" that Billy will carry out his father's wishes. Perhaps he will. But how would you respond to this plan if you were Billy's wife? Think for a moment. Your husband is paying for his sisters' expensive clothing, luxury automobiles, vacations, and so on. Most spouses feel that charity begins at home. Note that spouses are often the initiators of family conflicts regarding inequities in the distribution of wealth.

The other participants did not criticize Mr. Andrews's plan directly. When each spoke, he looked at the group in general, not at Mr. Andrews. Yet it became increasingly clear as the discussion progressed that the other respondents rated the Andrews Plan a poor one.

One senior respondent reflected on a related situation:

TABLE 6-5
ENTREPRENEUR-GIFTS AND INHERITANCE: CONTRASTS
AMONG THE ADULT CHILDREN OF THE AFFLUENT